

PROJECT ATLAS

EL BIERZO

La Lomba / Compostilla

GATE 1 INVESTMENT & INFRASTRUCTURE DOSSIER · v2.0

Candidate	EU-ES-04
Region	El Bierzo, León, Castilla y León, Spain
Research date	12 August 2026
Method	Falsification-first
Decision	CONTINUE RESEARCHING
Geographic focus	Redirected from Compostilla to La Lomba / Ponferrada corridor

PUBLIC RESEARCH VERSION

This is not a promotional document. Project Atlas is an independent research and validation programme. No land, financing, customers, permits or secured grid capacity are claimed at this candidate. The purpose of this dossier is to test whether the location survives falsification.

The central finding

The former coal plant is not the electrical opportunity. The neighbouring La Lomba 220 kV node may be.

1. Executive decision

GATE 1 — CONTINUE RESEARCHING

Candidate redirected from Compostilla to the La Lomba / Ponferrada corridor.

The original coal-to-compute hypothesis is partially falsified. Compostilla 400 kV — the node most obviously associated with the former ~1 GW power station — has 0 MW of published margin for new demand. The binding constraint is dynamic behaviour at zonal level, not lack of static or short-circuit headroom.

The investigation nevertheless identified a stronger electrical position nearby: La Lomba 220 kV in Ponferrada shows 602 MW of published demand margin under the general criterion and 0 MW of pending demand requests in the 3 August 2026 REE file.

This does not establish a financeable data-centre site. Fibre diversity, controllable land, connection timing, operator demand, water, flood exposure and geotechnical conditions remain unproven.

Primary opportunity: 602 MW published demand margin at La Lomba 220 kV.

Primary blocker: no controllable site + no verified diverse fibre + no operator demand.

Compostilla 400 kV: rejected as the primary connection point.

Atlas Demand Level: 0 — no reservation, LOI or qualified demand evidence.

2. The decisive grid evidence

Node	Demand margin (FRT-capable)	Available demand	Binding constraint	Atlas reading
Compostilla 400 kV	0 MW	0 MW	Dynamic, zonal	Reject as primary connection point
Compostilla 220 kV	205 MW	350 MW	Static demand, nodal	Published headroom exists, but queue exceeds it
La Lomba 400 kV	0 MW	0 MW	Dynamic, zonal	Not the opportunity
La Lomba 220 kV	602 MW	0 MW	Static demand, zonal	Best identified electrical position
Cornatel 220 kV	70 MW	0 MW	Static demand, nodal	Secondary comparator

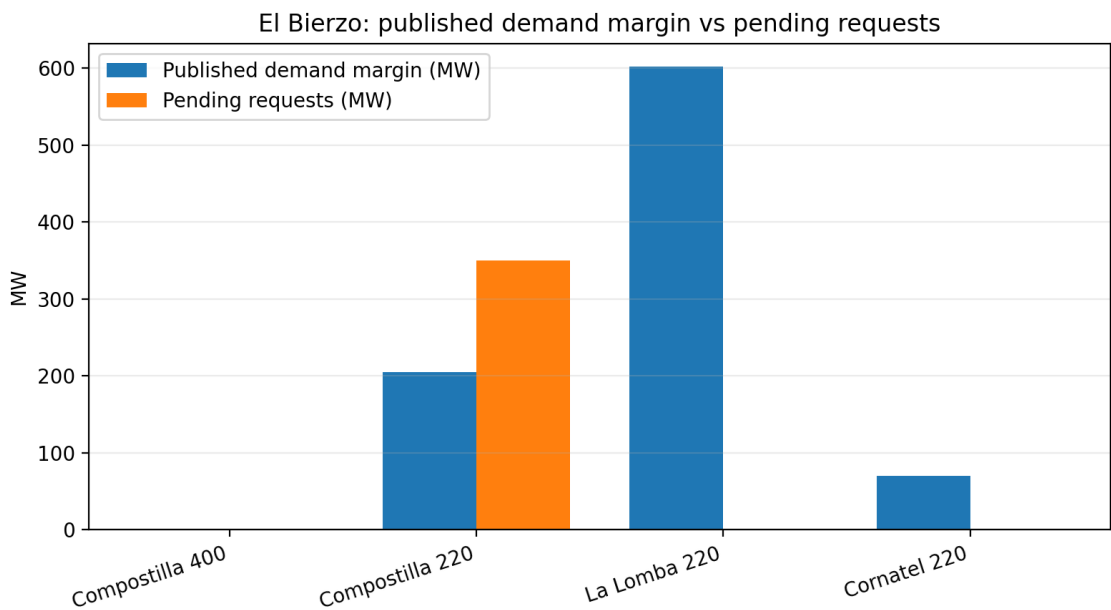


Figure 1. Grid-margin comparison prepared for the v2 dossier. Values reflect the source dossier's reading of REE's 03/08/2026 demand-capacity publication.

Why this matters

Historic export capability and present-day import capability are different regulatory and technical objects. A synchronous generator contributes inertia and short-circuit strength; a large AI facility presents converter-interfaced demand. Under the Spanish demand-access methodology, the published margin is determined by the most restrictive applicable criterion. At Compostilla 400 kV, large static and WSCR headroom is reduced to zero by the dynamic zonal criterion.

The lesson is portable: do not screen former thermal sites by voltage level or historic generation capacity alone. Screen the published demand-capacity file, the limiting criterion and the queue first.

3. Scale envelope

Phase	Scale	Compostilla 400	Compostilla 220	La Lomba 220
A	10-25 MW	Unsupported	Plausible on paper; queue blocks practicality	Plausible within published margin
B	50-100 MW	Unsupported	Depends entirely on 350 MW queue outcome	Plausible
C	200-500+ MW	Unsupported	Unlikely; margin insufficient before queue	Potentially plausible toward ~400 MW; zonal sharing m

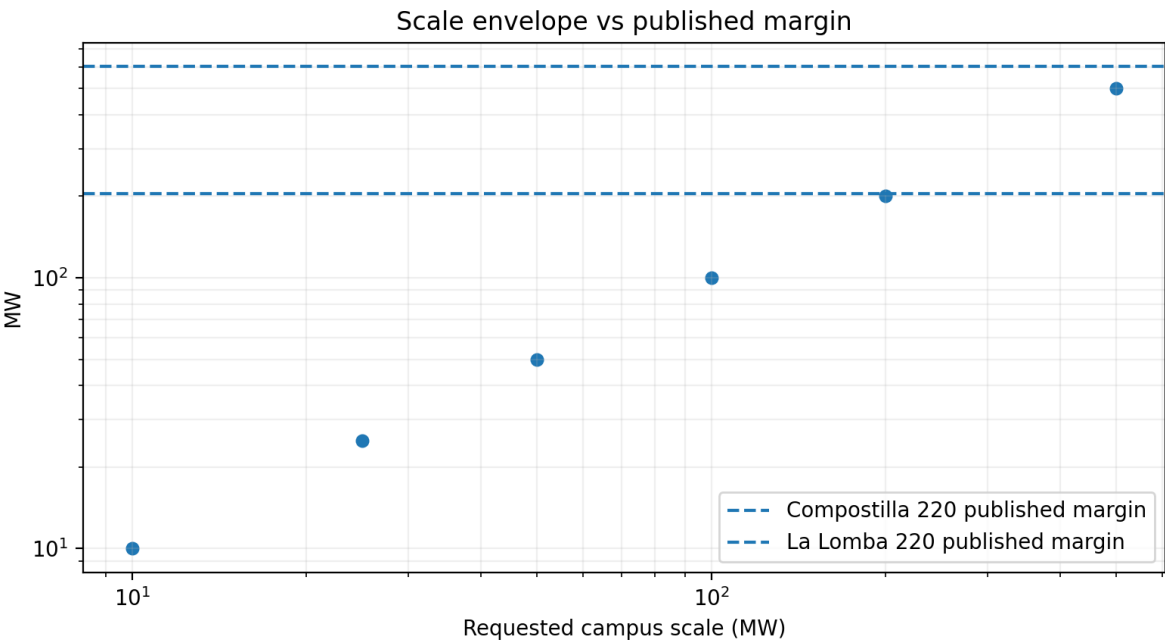


Figure 2. Screening envelope only. Published margin is not a reservation, connection offer or energisation commitment. A 600 MW campus should not be treated as the default design target. The evidence supports a phased screening logic. A 10-25 MW first phase is materially easier to place than a 200-500 MW campus, and a modular path preserves optionality while grid, fibre and commercial evidence are developed.

4. Geographic thesis: El Bierzo, not only Compostilla

The candidate should now be described externally as El Bierzo — La Lomba / Compostilla. Compostilla remains relevant for land, industrial legacy, transition policy and possible 220 kV optionality. The electrical centre of gravity identified by the research has shifted toward La Lomba 220 kV in Ponferrada.

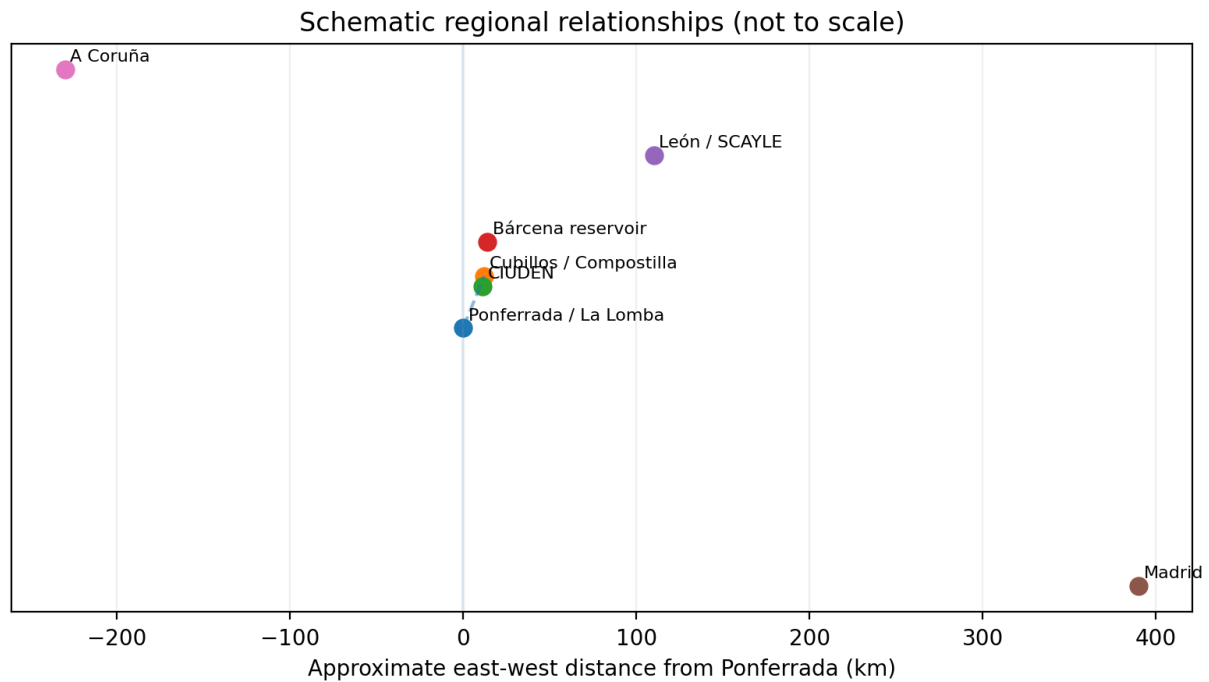


Figure 3. Schematic candidate geography. This is not a cadastral or connection map and does not imply site control. The source dossier places La Lomba roughly 10–14 km from Cubillos del Sil. That distance is close enough to justify treating the assets as one regional screening corridor, but too far to assume that former-plant land can simply use La Lomba without a defined connection design, route, rights and cost.

5. Land and site control

Parameter	Current finding	Classification
Former plant area	~330 ha	Verified in source dossier
Industrially zoned	~80 ha	Verified in source dossier
Unassigned industrial land	64 ha stated in Sep 2021; Aug 2026 position unknown	Mixed / requires validation
Ownership	Endesa	Verified
Third-party control route	Futur-e committee process; no open-market route established	Strong indication
Contamination / ash liabilities	Not established	Unknown
Geotechnical conditions	Not established	Unknown

The main land risk is control, not acreage. The dossier found that the former plant land has been allocated through the Futur-e evaluation process, with employment and transition considerations. A data centre is capital-intensive but relatively employment-light, so Atlas should not assume that a technically suitable parcel can be acquired on ordinary commercial terms.

No parcel-level cadastral map is presented in this public v2. That omission is deliberate: no cadastral references, urban-plan overlays or decommissioning boundary drawings were established in the source research.

6. Connectivity: unresolved and potentially fatal

No route-level evidence in the source dossier proves two physically diverse carrier paths serving either Cubillos del Sil or the preferred La Lomba / Ponferrada corridor. Presence of telecom operators in the region is not equivalent to financeable data-centre connectivity.

Gate 2 should require:

- Two physically diverse routes, not two commercial products riding the same duct or corridor.
- A defined path to a major interconnection ecosystem such as Madrid, and a credible secondary route.
- Carrier confirmation of dark fibre or equivalent high-capacity wholesale service, lead time and construction dependency.
- A route-level view of single points of failure.

Until those points are confirmed, fibre remains a potential kill criterion for any scale above a small first phase.

7. What the coal-to-compute hypothesis got wrong

Compostilla is useful precisely because it falsifies a common shortcut. A former gigawatt-scale generator can sit beside high-voltage infrastructure and still have zero published margin for a new large load.

The Spanish framework evaluates demand against short-circuit strength, static behaviour and dynamic behaviour, at nodal and/or zonal level. The minimum applicable result determines the usable margin. At Compostilla 400 kV the limiting criterion is dynamic and zonal, so a local intervention aimed only at short-circuit strength does not solve the published constraint.

Atlas screening rule

TSO demand capacity → limiting criterion → queue → fibre → land → hazards → operator demand.

This should replace the weaker sequence: former power station → large substation → large site → presumed opportunity.

8. Risk register

Risk	Why it matters	Current view	Gate consequence
La Lomba margin is consumed	602 MW is zonal, not reserved	High monitoring priority	Reject if <50 MW and no alternative node
No diverse fibre	Single path is not financeable at scale	Unresolved	Reject above Phase A if no second route
Land cannot be controlled	No site = no project	Unresolved	Reject if no alternative near La Lomba
Atlas cannot secure access points	Guarantees and consumption commitment require national counterparty	Unlikely	Requires development/financial partner
Connection timeline slips beyond 2031	Misses current AI capital cycle	Unknown	Reject if confirmed
Flood / geotechnical issue	Could make preferred parcel uneconomic	Unknown	Parcel-level kill criterion
No operator demand	Technical site without customer is not investable	No evidence yet	Three qualified declines on fundamentals = reject

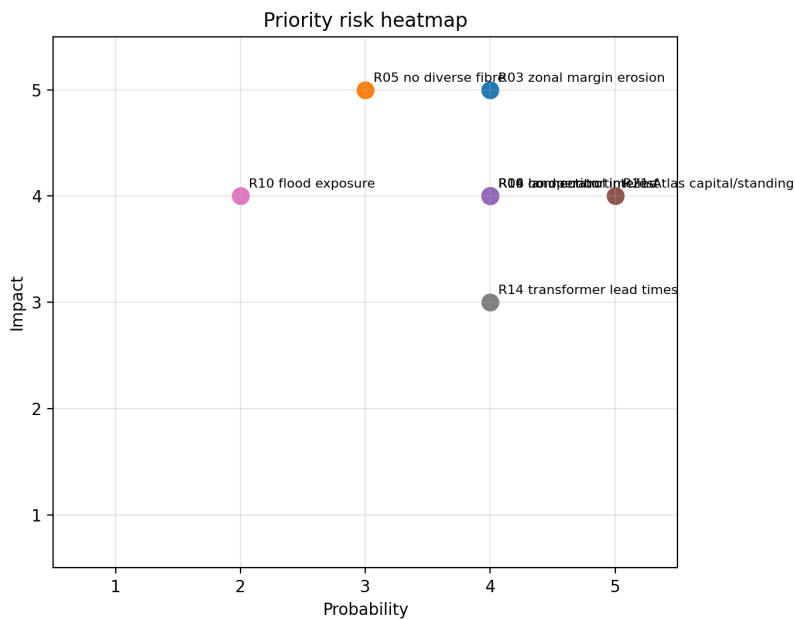


Figure 4. v2 risk visualisation. It summarises the source dossier; it does not upgrade unknown evidence.

9. Atlas scorecard — opportunity separated from evidence

Domain	Opportunity (0-5)	Evidence confidence (0-5)	Comment
Power / grid	4.5	4.5	Exceptional published margin at La Lomba 220; zonal and unreserved
Land / control	3.0	2.5	Large industrial legacy, but control path unresolved
Fibre	2.5	1.0	Regional plausibility only; no route-level proof
Water / cooling	3.0	1.5	Infrastructure exists; rights and design envelope unverified
Hazards / ground	2.5	1.0	Parcel-specific flood and geotechnics not established
Permitting / transition	3.5	3.0	Strong industrial-transition context; data-centre fit unproven
Commercial demand	2.5	0.5	No qualified operator demand established
Delivery timing	3.5	2.5	Site clearance timing attractive; grid energisation date unknown

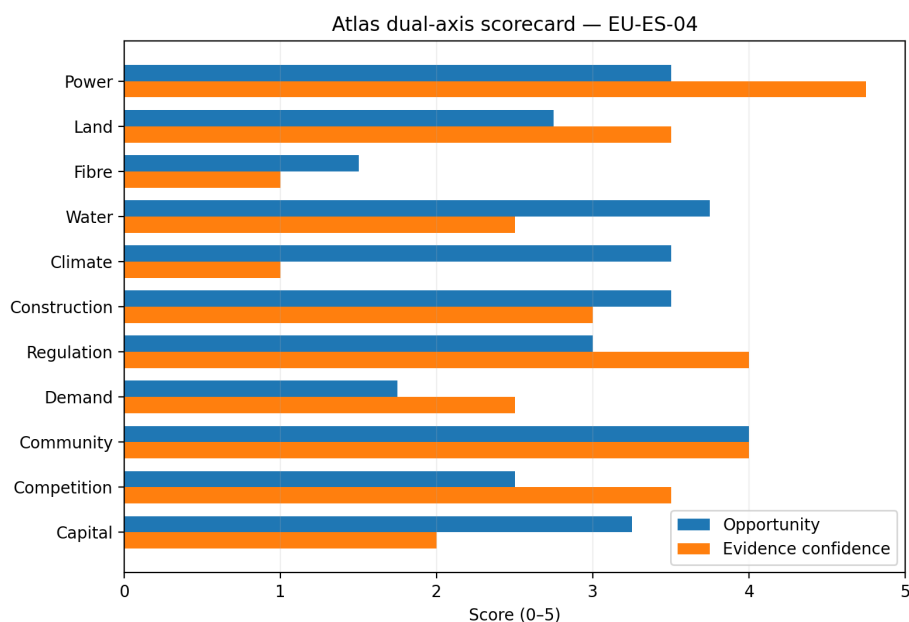


Figure 5. Opportunity and evidence are deliberately scored separately. A high opportunity score cannot compensate for weak evidence.

The scorecard is a screening aid, not an investment rating. The candidate should not be advanced merely because its opportunity profile is attractive. Gate advancement depends on closing the specific evidence gaps.

10. What is not yet proven

Unknown	Why it blocks	Required evidence
La Lomba connectionability for a specific project	Proposed margin is not a connection offer	REE process confirmation + project-specific access path
Zonal composition E329_SEPE	602 MW may be shared with competing nodes	REE zone definition and competing demand review
Land within practical reach of La Lomba	Electrical opportunity needs a developable site	Parcel shortlist + ownership + zoning + control path
Fibre diversity	Can kill the commercial product	Carrier route maps / written confirmation
Flood exposure	Can kill a parcel	SNCZI parcel-level check
Geotechnical / contamination condition	Can materially alter cost	Phase I/II environmental + geotechnical investigation
Water / discharge rights	Cooling concept remains open	Authority / utility confirmation
Operator demand	No customer thesis yet	Qualified operator conversations / LOI ladder
Energisation timeline	Determines commercial relevance	Indicative connection programme

11. Kill criteria

- La Lomba 220 kV falls below 50 MW of available demand margin, with no other node in El Bierzo above that threshold.
- REE confirms the Compostilla 220 kV queue is firm and the La Lomba zonal margin is effectively consumed by the same or a related project.
- No carrier will commit to a second physically diverse fibre path at a commercially conceivable cost.
- No controllable and compliant land can be secured near the preferred electrical position.
- Three qualified GPU-cloud or sovereign-AI operators decline on site fundamentals rather than timing or capital.
- A credible connection timeline is established beyond 2031.
- A preferred parcel lies in a significant flood-risk area or has ground liabilities that cannot be engineered around economically.

Not kill criteria

Compostilla 400 kV showing zero kills that node, not the entire regional candidate. Absence of hyperscaler interest alone is not fatal because hyperscalers are not the only target operator profile.

12. Immediate validation programme

Priority	Action	Output
1	Read the latest REE demand-capacity file for La Lomba, Compostilla and related parcels, queues and limiting criteria	Updated map, queue and limiting criteria
2	Check whether La Lomba 220 appears on REE's non-expandable-substation list	Expansion constraint status
3	Resolve the composition of E329_SEPE	Nodes sharing the 602 MW zonal margin
4	Run SNCZI flood screening on candidate parcels / corridors	Early parcel kill screen
5	Ask REE about the 350 MW Compostilla 220 queue	Expected resolution and practical remaining headroom
6	Issue carrier RFIs for Ponferrada / Cubillos del Sil	Two-route connectivity evidence
7	Identify land within practical electrical reach of La Lomba	Parcel shortlist and control path

Do the free desk checks before broad outreach. They have higher information value than generic stakeholder conversations.

13. Thirty-day Gate 1 closure plan

GRID

Obtain written clarification on the Compostilla queue, verify La Lomba's current monthly margin, understand E329_SEPE competition and define the formal path for a 10–25 MW and 50–100 MW load.

FIBRE

Contact Lyntia, Telefónica/Movistar wholesale, MasOrange wholesale, Adamo and Asteo or equivalent carriers. Require physical diversity, PoP location, route dependency and lead time.

LAND

Build a parcel shortlist around the preferred electrical corridor. Confirm ownership, zoning, access, developable area, environmental history and realistic control structure.

COMMERCIAL

Test the site with qualified GPU-cloud, sovereign-AI and infrastructure operators. Capture required MW, delivery date, latency/connectivity constraints and willingness to discuss an LOI.

ENGINEERING

Run flood, water, geotechnical and contamination screens only on parcels that survive grid, fibre and control tests.

14. Gate 2 advancement rule

Do not advance because 602 MW appears in a spreadsheet. Advance only when the electrical opportunity can be paired with a real site and a real connectivity path.

Minimum evidence package for **CONDITIONAL PASS**

- Non-zero, current published demand margin at the intended node and a credible project-specific access route.
- Two physically diverse carrier paths confirmed or contractually buildable.
- At least one controllable, planning-compatible parcel within a credible connection envelope.
- No parcel-level fatal flood, contamination or geotechnical issue identified at screening level.
- At least one qualified operator conversation that does not reject the location on fundamentals.

If those conditions are met, Atlas can move from Continue Researching to Conditional Pass. Until then, capital-intensive development work should remain limited.

15. Development strategy if the candidate survives

The evidence does not support jumping directly to a 600 MW macro-campus. A more robust development thesis is modular:

- Phase A: 10–25 MW — prove grid process, fibre, land and operator demand.
- Phase B: 50–100 MW — expand only after access position and commercial demand are materially de-risked.
- Phase C: 200–400 MW — consider only if the zonal margin, network reinforcement and land envelope support it.

This approach reduces the amount of capital committed before the most important unknowns are resolved and is consistent with the central finding of the dossier: grid access is asymmetric, dynamic and scarce.

16. Final investment conclusion

CONTINUE RESEARCHING

The Compostilla thesis did not survive in its original form. The famous 400 kV legacy node has zero published margin for new demand. That is a negative result and should remain prominent.

But the research found something better: La Lomba 220 kV shows 602 MW of published, unreserved demand margin with no pending demand requests in the source dossier's 3 August 2026 REE dataset. That is sufficiently unusual in the Spanish 2026 grid context to justify a redirected Gate 1 investigation.

The candidate is therefore no longer best understood as a former coal-plant redevelopment. It is a regional infrastructure-origination thesis: can Atlas pair the La Lomba electrical position with controllable land, diverse fibre and real operator demand?

The former coal plant is not the asset. The neighbouring substation may be.

Next decision: prove fibre + land + grid connectionability before Gate 2.

Appendix A. Evidence discipline

VERIFIED — directly supported in the source dossier by a primary source such as REE, CNMC, BOE, MITECO, municipal material or a company statement about its own assets.

STRONG INDICATION — consistently reported by multiple credible sources but with a critical primary confirmation still outstanding.

INFERENCE — reasoned from verified facts; reasoning must remain visible and attackable.

UNKNOWN — not established. No positive claim should be made.

VALIDATE — material to the decision and best resolved by direct contact with the responsible counterparty.

This v2 is an editorial restructuring of the 12 August 2026 EU-ES-04 Gate 1 dossier. It does not independently upgrade any source classification or introduce new external research. Internal outreach copy has been removed from the public-facing structure.

Appendix B. Primary source families carried forward

Source family	Use in the dossier
Red Eléctrica de España (REE)	Demand-access capacity, node margins, limiting criteria, queue context, planning
CNMC	Demand-access methodology and regulatory framework
BOE	Access-and-connection rules, closure and formal legal acts
MITECO / Instituto para la Transición Justa	Transition framework, public procedures and official programme context
Endesa	Former Compostilla assets, decommissioning, Futur-e and company statements
Municipal / regional authorities	Planning, local transition and land-context evidence
Carrier counterparties	Required future validation for fibre routes and diversity

For investment or legal reliance, the underlying primary documents should be opened and re-checked at the date of decision. REE demand capacity is monthly and can change.

END OF PUBLIC GATE 1 DOSSIER · v2.0